

WHICH EXTENSION DO I USE?

Claude Code Decision Flowchart

Ask yourself the question on the left. Follow the arrow to the right answer.

"I want Claude to ALWAYS follow this rule, every session" e.g. never use console.log, always use TypeScript strict mode	→	CLAUDE.md	Always loaded, every session
"I want rules that only apply to CERTAIN files" e.g. different rules for test files vs production code	→	Rules	.claude/rules/*.md - path-specific
"I keep typing the same prompt over and over" e.g. generate commit messages, review code, write tests	→	Skill	/command - reusable prompt
"I need to GUARANTEE something never happens" e.g. block rm -rf, auto-lint on save, prevent force push	→	Hook	100% deterministic, shell scripts
"I want Claude to do a task in isolation, without polluting context" e.g. research 50 files, deep code review, explore codebase	→	Subagent	Own context, reports back
"I want MULTIPLE agents working at the same time" e.g. 3 agents reviewing security, performance, and tests in parallel	→	Agent Team	Coordinated, git worktrees
"I want Claude to connect to an external tool or API" e.g. GitHub, database, Slack, Figma, browser automation	→	MCP Server	stdio / sse / http transport
"I want to package and share my setup with others" e.g. distribute skills + hooks + agents as one installable bundle	→	Plugin	Namespaced, npm/GitHub

KEY INSIGHT
CLAUDE.md & Hooks are DETERMINISTIC - they run every time, no exceptions.
Skills & Agents are PROBABILISTIC - Claude uses judgment about when to apply them.

Quick:
CLAUDE.md = memory Rules = conditional Skills = /commands Hooks = guardrails
Subagents = isolated Teams = parallel MCP = external Plugins = share